

partnership between bitcoin exchanges is projected to bring the fee down to 0.5 percent for remittances into the country.¹⁰ In Mexico, there's been a huge surge in volume at the country's bitcoin exchange, Bitso, where funds can be transferred for a similarly low fee.¹¹ All of these companies are eyeing the tens of billions of dollars the incumbents make from levying fat fees on vulnerable customers.

The impact of this major disruption in the remittance market should be recognized by the innovative investor not only because of the threat it creates to a publicly traded company like Western Union (WU) but for the opportunities it provides as well. For example, Bitso secured startup funding through the online investment service bnktothefuture.com, which, as we discussed in [Chapter 16](#), connects investors with cryptoasset startups.¹²

Business-to-Business Payments and Blockchain Technology

Sending money internationally goes beyond citizens, as businesses also transmit large volumes to global business partners. While this industry is too large to dive into every detail, the same story laid out in remittances applies: fees are generally higher than they should be, and payments are slower than they should be. Visa, for example, has sensed the opportunity and is working with a startup called Chain to build a business-to-business payment solution using blockchain technology.¹³ BitPesa is another company that leverages